

ValueError: unsupported pickle protocol: 3, python2 pickle can not load the file dumped by python 3 pickle?

I use pickle to dump a file on python 3, and I use pickle to load the file on python 2, the ValueError appears.

So, python 2 pickle can not load the file dumped by python 3 pickle?

If I want it? How to do?

[python](#) [python-2.7](#) [python-3.x](#) [pickle](#)

asked Sep 15 '14 at 8:26



[Aleeee](#)

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1 If you are stuck with already-written pickled files, then check out: stackoverflow.com/questions/34571063/... — [rysqui](#) Jan 3 '16 at 1:58

3 Answers

You should write the pickled data with a lower protocol number in Python 3. Python 3 introduced a new protocol with the number 3 (and uses it as default), so switch back to a value of 2 which can be read by Python 2.

Check the `protocol` parameter in `pickle.dump`. Your resulting code will look like this.

```
pickle.dump(your_object, your_file, protocol=2)
```

There is no `protocol` parameter in `pickle.load` because `pickle` can determine the protocol from the file.

edited Sep 15 '14 at 8:34

answered Sep 15 '14 at 8:29



[Matthias](#)

5,742 3 24 33

```
pickle.dump(your_object, your_file, protocol=2)
```

For the above statement, can you please state what should I write for 'your_object'? And I assume 'your_file' means file location, Am I correct?

deleted by owner Sep 8 '16 at 21:45

answered Sep 8 '16 at 21:45



[Jaimit Patel](#)

1 1

Pickle uses different `protocols` to convert your data to a binary stream.

- In python 2 there are [3 different protocols](#) (0 , 1 , 2) and the default is 0 .
- In python 3 there are [5 different protocols](#) (0 , 1 , 2 , 3 , 4) and the default is 3 .

You must specify in python 3 a protocol lower than 3 in order to be able to load the data in python 2. You can specify the `protocol` parameter when invoking `pickle.dump`.

answered Sep 15 '14 at 8:32



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